

State of Alaska – Office of the Governor — 34th Alaska State Legislature – Second Session
DEPARTMENT REVIEW – PASSED LEGISLATION

BLUE SHEET

Blue Sheets are a department's final bill analysis and provides the Commissioner an opportunity to weigh in on legislation that has passed, with a recommendation to the Governor on action that may be taken– to enact the bill, to veto the bill, or to allow the bill to become Law without signature (LWOS). Much of the information requested in the Blue Sheet can be taken from the department's bill analyses (BA), which were initially submitted at the time the bill was introduced and updated throughout the legislative process.

Blue sheets are due to the GLO three days after the enrolled bill appears on basis, or sooner by request.

Department: DEED

Date: 5/20/2026

Bill Number: HB 39

Short Title (as it appears on BASIS): Education for Deaf & Hard of Hearing

What action do you recommend the Governor take?

Select one.

☒ **SIGN** ☐ **VETO** ☐ **LWOS**

Action Justification – Why do you recommend the above action?

Please be specific.

House Bill 39 strengthens parental choice and educational supports for Alaska students who are deaf or hard of hearing. The bill ensures parents receive comprehensive, neutral, and unbiased information regarding communication methods, hearing technology, services, and educational programming so families can make informed decisions that best meet the needs of their child. The legislation also supports the availability of one or more statewide programs for deaf students, including programs that may provide residential educational services, helping address longstanding access and service delivery challenges for students and families across Alaska, particularly in remote and rural communities. The bill promotes individualized educational opportunities for students and improved access to specialized educational services statewide.

What does this Bill do?

In addition to providing a succinct bill summary, please also consider the following: Why is this bill needed? How does it specifically change department programs? What is the anticipated impact on the public, the private sector? Does this bill align with the priorities of Governor Dunleavy?

This bill relates to students in public schools who are deaf or hard of hearing in Alaska. It amends [AS 14.30.272 Procedural safeguards](#) by requiring school districts to provide comprehensive, neutral, and unbiased information regarding hearing technology, communication

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methods, services, programs, and support available to parents of children who are deaf or hard of hearing. The bill allows parents to choose the method of communication that is most appropriate for their child and requires services to be delivered by professionals with training, experience, and a background in the chosen method of communication. The bill also directs the department to support one or more programs for the deaf, which may, but are not required to, provide residential services as part of its educational program and can be operated by a school district under an agreement with the department.

Detailed Sectional Analysis

The full sectional analysis of the bill should be completed by the lead agency. Other departments should include an analysis for sections of the bill affecting their agencies.

Section 1: Amends [AS 14.30.272](#) *Procedural safeguards*, by adding new subsections that ensure that the educational needs of deaf and hard of hearing students in Alaska are met by providing parents with unbiased information and allowing them to choose the best method of communication for their child. Additionally, the act establishes a centralized program for deaf students that provides residential services as part of its educational program.

Section 2: Amends [AS 14.30.276](#) *Least Restrictive environment*, by requiring the Department of Education and Early Development to support one or more programs for the deaf to be made available to people who are deaf in the state. Programs may provide residential services as part of its educational program and may be operated by a school district under an agreement with the department. If a school district offers such a program, a plan of operation to the department for approval.

Additionally, the school district is only required to offer transportation to students who reside in the district. If a school district determines that placement in the program is appropriate for a child who resides in the district, the school district that makes the placement retains the school district's responsibilities for special education for that child under state and federal law.

Companion or Similar Bills

Please note companion legislation, the sponsor of the companion legislation, and identify any “rider” bills or provisions from other legislation that was included in this final bill. Please include the name of the sponsor of the “rider bill” or provision. If it was added as an amendment in a committee – please indicate the name of the legislator that sponsored the amendment.

SB 8 Sponsored by Senator Gray-Jackson

Support/Opposition of the Bill

Please identify names, organizations, titles, and phone numbers of those who testified in support or in opposition of this bill.

Testimony or letters in support:

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Sabrina Richmons, Chair, Governor’s Council on Disabilities and Special Education
Alaska Deaf Council

Testimony opposed:

- None

Bill Signing ceremony suggestions (if applicable)

Please provide information for consideration for a bill signing ceremony. Information that is helpful includes: a specific conference, event, venue, date, and the names and contact information of stakeholders who should be considered for an invitation to the bill signing ceremony.

Not Applicable

Commissioner’s Signature: _____  _____ **Date:** 5/20/2026

I have reviewed the above information and provided it to the Governor’s Legislative Office for consideration of an action by the Governor on legislation passed during the second session of the 34th Alaska State Legislature.

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